

UNIT 4: LIFE ISSUES

Chapter 33: Comprehensive Literary & Practical Syllabus

THE ALL-IN-ONE EXCELLENCE LIVRET

Syllabus Chapters Covered:	• 9. Job Ads (Page 232) • Arts Session 8: The Richer, The Poorer (Page 235) • Arts Session 9: A Secret for Two (Page 240) • Arts Session 10: What a Wonderful World! (Page 245)
Target Audience:	Tunisian Secondary Baccalaureate Students (All Streams / Sections)
Manual Features:	Course Theory, Advanced Grammar (Subjunctive), Phonetics, Model Essays, 40 Active Recall Flashcards, Diagnostic Exam & Summary Memos

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PART 1: THE EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

1.1. Chapter 9: Job Ads (Page 232)

Job advertisements are highly structured expository texts designed to attract qualified candidates. For the Baccalaureate exam, students must analyze the semantic components of **Job Ads** (Position, Salary, Requirements, Benefits) and master the formal conventions of the **Letter of Application**. In English, professional job ads rely on collocations and concise descriptive language to establish rigorous standards.

Semantic Component	Ad 1: Tourism Consulting Firm	Ad 2: Aston University (Economics)
Position Offered	Consultants and Project Team Leaders	Lecturer / Senior Lecturer / Reader in Economics
Salary / Benefits	Short/Long term projects; Global travel	£22,191 - £39,958 (exceptionally £43,067) per annum
Academic & Tech Requirements	Proficient in English & ideally another language	Good first degree and a doctorate in economics
Professional Commitment	Expertise in cultural, rural tourism, HR, conservation	Strong commitment to high-quality teaching & research
Application Process	Send CV with photograph electronically	Apply online (recruitment.htm) or quote Ref A03/54

The Formal Letter of Application (Règles d'Or d'Écriture) :

- 1. Clear Intent:** Open by stating the exact source and date of the advertisement (e.g., 'In reply to your advertisement in...').
- 2. Qualifications & Experience:** Match your personal assets directly to the ad's requirements. Use professional action verbs.
- 3. High Register (No Contractions):** Strictly avoid informal colloquialisms like 'I'm' or 'won't'. Write 'I am' and 'will not'.
- 4. Closing Formula:** Conclude with the standard professional formula: 'I look forward to hearing from you.' and use 'Yours faithfully' or 'Yours sincerely' followed by your full name.

1.2. Arts Session 8: The Richer, The Poorer (Page 235)

Written by **Dorothy West**, a prominent novelist, editor, and the youngest member of the **Harlem Renaissance**, this short story explores the deep psychological and socio-economic contrast between two sisters, **Lottie** and **Bess**, who choose opposite philosophies in life. Lottie is consumed by the fear of poverty, choosing extreme frugality, and retiring at sixty to realize she has lived a 'life never lived.' Bess, conversely, lives like a gypsy with her musician husband Harry, traveling and remaining penniless but deeply fulfilled and rich in love.

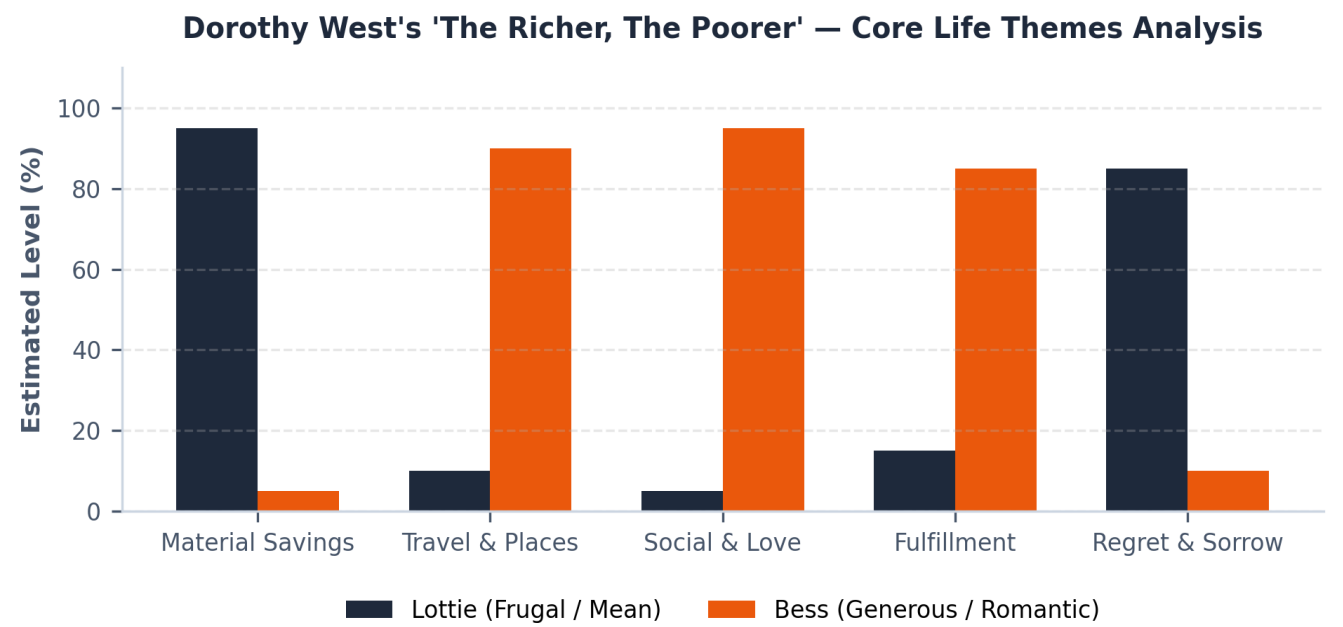


Figure 1.1: Dorothy West's 'The Richer, The Poorer' — Core Life Themes Analysis

Key Exam Idioms from Dorothy West's Text:

Idiom in the Text	Literal Meaning	Contextual & Rhetorical Meaning
A job in hand was worth two in the future.	A current job is safer.	Lottie left school to work full-time, prioritizing immediate financial security.
Often in rags and never in riches.	Wearing old clothes, poor.	Bess and Harry lived a highly unstable and impoverished life abroad.
Bess should reap the harvest of Lottie's self-denial.	Enjoying crops from another's effort.	Lottie felt it was unfair for Bess to enjoy the fruits of Lottie's lifelong sacrifices.
I'll sleep like a rock tonight.	Sleeping very deeply.	Bess was physically exhausted but completely peaceful and stress-free.

1.3. Arts Session 9: A Secret for Two (Page 240)

A Secret for Two by Quentin Reynolds tells the moving story of Pierre Dupin and his white horse Joseph, who worked for 30 years for the Provincial Milk Company in Montreal. They shared a profound secret: **Pierre had been completely blind due to cataracts for five years**, and Joseph guided the milk wagon perfectly along the route without any complaints. When Joseph died of old age at 25, Pierre was devastated, lost his guide, and was instantly hit and killed by a truck. This story highlights themes of friendship, devotion, and mutual reliance.

Grammar Mastery: The Subjunctive Mood (L'Expression de l'Urgence) :

The **Subjunctive mood** is used to express necessity, urgency, demands, or recommendations. It is highly valued in Baccalaureate essays because of its formal register. In the subjunctive, we use the **base form** of the verb (bare infinitive) for all persons, including the third person singular, and **be** (not is/are) or **not be** for the negative.

Form: Subject + Verb (suggest / insist / recommend / demand) + THAT + Subject + **BASE FORM**

- Example 1: Jacques suggested that Pierre **be** retired and given a small pension.
- Example 2: He insisted that the new recruit **sign** a contract immediately.
- Example 3: It is essential that a scientist **not be** indifferent to social ethics.
- Example 4: The company demanded that new trucks **take** over the route.

1.4. Arts Session 10: What a Wonderful World! (Page 245)

This lesson centers around the immortal song **What a Wonderful World** by **Louis Armstrong** (1901-1971), originally released in 1968 in Great Britain. Armstrong, born in extreme poverty in New Orleans, spent his childhood with his grandmother Josephine, was arrested at age 11 for firing a pistol on New Year's Eve, and was sent to the Colored Waif's Home for Boys where he received his musical training. The song uses rich natural imagery (green trees, red roses, blue skies, white clouds, and the rainbow) to express optimism and hope. The 'growing babies' symbolize the future and potential of humanity.

Thematic Vocabulary Portfolio (Syllabus Chapter 33) :

Word / Phrase	Part of Speech	Textbook Context	French Translation
proficient	adjective	Candidates must be proficient in English	compétent / maîtrisant
penniless / penurious	adjective	Left Lottie's parents penniless	sans le sou / indigent
frugally	adverb	Lottie lived frugally to prepare for retirement	frugalement / économiquement
grieve	verb	Bess grieved because she had no children	s'affliger / pleurer
reap the harvest	verb phrase	Bess reaped the harvest of Lottie's sacrifice	récolter les fruits de
limp / hobble	verb	Pierre limped down the street slowly	boiter / claudiquer
panic-stricken	adjective	Pierre was panic-stricken at retirement	paniqué / terrifié
bloom	verb	I see red roses bloom for me and you	fleurir / s'épanouir
blessed / sacred	adjective	Bright blessed days, dark sacred nights	béni / sacré

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY (40 Q&A;)

Ce recueil de **40 questions-réponses clés** est spécialement conçu pour une révision active par cache-cache. Pliez la page ou cachez la colonne de droite pour vous auto-évaluer sur les questions d'examen.

Questions Types (FOLD HERE)	Model Solutions (Excellence Standard)
Q1: What positions does Ad 1 offer and who is seeking them?	Ad 1 is from Europe's leading international tourism consulting firm, which urgently seeks Consultants and Project Team Leaders.
Q2: What are the main geographical regions targeted for projects in Ad 1?	The consulting firm targets projects in Asia, the Middle East, Latin America, and the Caribbean.
Q3: What are the language requirements listed in Ad 1?	Candidates must be proficient in English and ideally in at least one other foreign language.
Q4: What academic credentials are required for the Aston Business School position?	Applicants must hold a good first degree and a doctorate in economics.
Q5: What is the primary focus of the Aston University ad?	It seeks candidates with a strong commitment to high-quality teaching, research, and publishing in leading journals.
Q6: What is the annual salary range for the lecturer position in Ad 2?	The salary ranges from £22,191 to £39,958 (exceptionally rising to £43,067) per annum.
Q7: What is the absolute deadline for applications in Ad 2?	The closing date for applications is 4 April.
Q8: List three key elements to include in a formal letter of application.	1. The source and position applied for. 2. Relevant qualifications and experience. 3. A formal closing (no contractions).
Q9: Who wrote 'The Richer, The Poorer' and what was her social background?	Dorothy West (1907-1998) was the daughter of an emancipated slave and lived in a well-to-do black family in Boston.
Q10: Why was Dorothy West famous in American literature?	She was known as the youngest of the Harlem Renaissance writers and published 'The Living Is Easy' in 1948.
Q11: What is Lottie's primary life goal in 'The Richer, The Poorer'?	Lottie's goal is to acquire wealth, save money, and prepare meticulously for her old age to escape childhood poverty.

Questions Types (FOLD HERE)	Model Solutions (Excellence Standard)
Q12: How does Lottie's childhood poverty affect her behavior?	Hating her parents' struggle to make ends meet, she starts working after school in a variety store at age twelve and hoarding money.
Q13: Contrast Bess's attitude toward money and saving with Lottie's.	Bess lives each day as if there were no other, marries Harry immediately, travels, lives like a gypsy, and saves absolutely nothing.
Q14: Explain Lottie's choice in her last year of high school.	She chose full-time work over staying in school, applying the proverb: 'A job in hand is worth two in the future.'
Q15: What is the tragic irony of Lottie's life when she retires at sixty?	She realizes she has saved all her money but has a 'life never lived,' without ever enjoying a single day or dollar.
Q16: How did Bess and Harry live their married life?	They lived like gypsies with Harry playing in second-rate bands abroad, often in rags and never in riches.
Q17: What does Lottie mean by being 'trapped by the blood tie'?	She feels a moral and familial obligation to send for Bess and take her in, despite Bess's lifetime of financial carelessness.
Q18: What is the moral lesson that Bess teaches Lottie at the end of the story?	Bess tells Lottie not to waste the remaining years feeling sorry for herself, but to start catching up and learning how to live.
Q19: Who wrote 'A Secret for Two' and where is the story set?	Quentin Reynolds wrote the story. It is set in Montreal, Canada, around the Provincial Milk Company.
Q20: Who are the two old friends in 'A Secret for Two' and what was their job?	Pierre Dupin, an elderly milk-wagon driver, and Joseph, his intelligent white horse. They delivered milk together for 30 years.
Q21: Why does Pierre refuse to retire when suggested by Jacques?	Pierre was terrified of being separated from Joseph, insisting they are two old men who must 'wear out together.'
Q22: What tragic news does Jacques deliver to Pierre one cold morning?	Jacques tells Pierre that Joseph died peacefully in his sleep at age 25 (equivalent to 75 for a man).
Q23: What was the 'secret' shared between Pierre and Joseph?	Pierre had been completely blind due to cataracts for five years, and Joseph knew the route so perfectly he guided the wagon alone.
Q24: How did Pierre die immediately after Joseph's death?	Grief-stricken, Pierre hobbled down the street sobbing and walked right into the path of a huge speeding truck, dying instantly.

Questions Types (FOLD HERE)	Model Solutions (Excellence Standard)
Q25: What did the ambulance doctor discover about Pierre's eyes?	The doctor discovered that Pierre had severe cataracts and had been completely blind for five years.
Q26: What is the grammatical purpose of the Subjunctive mood?	It is used in formal, impersonal English to express urgency, demands, proposals, recommendations, or strong advice.
Q27: What base form is used in the subjunctive after 'suggest that...'? 	We use the bare infinitive (e.g., 'Jacques suggested that the milkman *be* retired' and 'he recommended that he *go*').
Q28: Rewrite using the Subjunctive: 'The president insists on a contract signature.'	The president insists that the candidate *sign* the contract immediately.
Q29: Rewrite using the Subjunctive: 'It is important for him to be on time.'	It is important that he *be* on time.
Q30: Who sang 'What a Wonderful World!' and what was his hometown?	Louis Armstrong (1901-1971) sang it, and he was born in a poor section of New Orleans, Louisiana.
Q31: What happened to Louis Armstrong at age eleven?	He fired a pistol to celebrate New Year's Eve, was arrested, and sent to the Colored Waif's Home for Boys.
Q32: Where did Louis Armstrong get his first professional music gigs?	Performing on river boats traveling up and down the Mississippi River in 1919.
Q33: When and where did 'What a Wonderful World!' become a massive hit?	It became a huge hit in Great Britain in 1968, three years before his death.
Q34: What is the general tone of 'What a Wonderful World!'?	The tone is highly optimistic, joyous, peaceful, and warm, celebrating love and nature.
Q35: What does the image of 'growing babies' symbolize in the song?	It symbolizes future generations, renewal, hope, and the continuous progress of a beautiful world.
Q36: Explain the difference between 'breathe' and 'breath'.	'Breathe' is a verb with a long /i:/ and /ð/, while 'breath' is a noun with a short /e/ and /θ/.
Q37: Classify the pronunciation of 'gh' in 'enough', 'thought', and 'though'.	In 'enough', 'gh' is pronounced /f/. In 'thought' and 'though', it is completely silent.

Questions Types (FOLD HERE)	Model Solutions (Excellence Standard)
Q38: Identify the silent letters in the words 'doubt' and 'knaves'.	In 'doubt', the letter 'b' is silent. In 'knaves', the letter 'k' is silent.
Q39: What is the primary word stress shift between the verb 'OR-gan-ise' and 'or-gan-i-SA-tion'?	The stress shifts from the first syllable in the verb to the fourth syllable in the noun.
Q40: Complete using the subjunctive: 'The company proposed that she (to be) hired.'	The company proposed that she *be* hired.

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PART 3: EXAM EVALUATION QUIZ

Ce quiz diagnostique est calibré sur les exigences de l'épreuve nationale du Baccalauréat. Répondez aux questions et justifiez vos réponses avant de consulter le corrigé.

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions (Grammar & Phonetics)

- 1. Complete the sentence:** The board of governors recommended that the candidate _____ their proposal before Monday.
a) reconsiders b) reconsider c) should reconsidered
- 2. Identify the word with a silent letter:**
a) robust b) knaves c) respect
- 3. In which of the following does 'gh' sound like /f/?**
a) through b) though c) enough
- 4. Complete:** The boss insisted that the new team leader _____ proficient in English.
a) is b) be c) was
- 5. Which syllable is stressed in 'organisation'?**
a) First b) Second c) Fourth

Section B: True or False with Justification (Textual Comprehension)

- 6. True or False:** Lottie graduated from high school and immediately went to Columbia University.
Justification: _____
- 7. True or False:** Bess lived a very secure, wealthy, and stable life abroad with her husband Harry.
Justification: _____
- 8. True or False:** None of the workers at the milk company knew Pierre Dupin was blind.
Justification: _____
- 9. True or False:** Louis Armstrong was born in a wealthy and privileged family in Great Britain.
Justification: _____
- 10. True or False:** In the subjunctive mood, we write 'suggest that he is retired'.
Justification: _____

Detailed Correction Key (Corrigé Pédagogique) :

1. **b) reconsider** — In subjunctive clauses following 'recommend that', we use the base form 'reconsider' for all subjects.
2. **b) knaves** — The letter 'k' is completely silent.
3. **c) enough** — The digraph 'gh' is pronounced /f/ in enough, but is silent in though and through.
4. **b) be** — Subjunctive mood requires the base form 'be' following 'insisted that'.
5. **c) Fourth** — The noun 'organisation' is stressed on the fourth syllable (or-gan-i-**SA**-tion).
6. **False** — Lottie did not graduate or attend Columbia (Dorothy West did). Lottie left school to work full-time after school.
7. **False** — Bess lived like a gypsy, often in rags and never in riches, as her husband played in second-rate bands.
8. **True** — Only his white horse Joseph knew his secret. Even Jacques, the foreman, and the president were kept in the dark.
9. **False** — Louis Armstrong was born in a very poor section of New Orleans, USA, not in a wealthy British family.
10. **False** — The subjunctive requires 'suggest that he **be** retired', using the base form 'be' instead of 'is'.

Tableaux de Synthèse (Mémors d'Excellence) :

Tableau Mémor 1.1: The Subjunctive Mood & Formal Linkers Matrix

Trigger Verb / Adj	Syntactic Rule	Common Bac Pitfalls to Avoid
suggest / insist / recommend	Subject + Verb + THAT + Subject + Base Form	Avoid adding '-s' or 'should' (e.g. 'suggested that he arrives' is wrong).
It is essential / important	It is + Adj + THAT + Subject + Base Form	Avoid using 'is/are' instead of 'be' (e.g. 'It is essential that he be proficient').
Negative Subjunctive	Subject + Verb + THAT + Subject + NOT + Verb	Do NOT use 'does not' or 'do not' (e.g. 'insisted he not fail' is correct).